

Lecture 3: Government Initiatives in Nepal

Digital Transformation of Public
Services

Digital Governance Initiatives in Nepal

- Nepal is undergoing digital transformation in public administration
 - Major focus areas:
 - Citizen digital identity systems
 - Online public service delivery
 - Digital payment integration
 - Broadband expansion and infrastructure development

Purpose of Government Digital Initiatives

- Improve service efficiency
- Reduce corruption risk
- Increase transparency
- Provide citizen-friendly access
- Support economic digitalization

Nagarik App – Purpose

- Centralized mobile citizen service platform
- Integrates multiple government services
- Reduces physical office dependency
- Acts as citizen digital interface

Nagarik App – Before vs After Scenario

- **Before:**
 - Multiple office visits
 - Paper document submission
 - Long queues
- **After:**
 - Online document upload
 - Service tracking
 - SMS or app notification

Nagarik App – Pros and Cons

- **Pros:**
 - Faster service delivery
 - Reduced paperwork
 - Transparency improvement
- **Cons:**
 - Requires smartphone and internet
 - Digital literacy gap
 - Server stability issues

Nagarik App Summary

- Purpose
 - Mobile-based citizen service platform
- Main Uses
 - Identity verification
 - Service tracking
 - Certificate download
- Why It Is Important
 - Reduces office visits
 - Improves service speed
 - Increases transparency
- Example Scenario
 - Citizen checks PAN verification from mobile.

ConnectIPS – Purpose

- **National digital payment gateway**
 - Used for tax payment
 - Used for examination fees
 - Used for government service charges
 - Promotes cashless transactions

ConnectIPS – Before vs After

- **Before:**
 - Travel to bank
 - Fill manual voucher
 - Submit payment physically
- **After:**
 - Pay online
 - Receive instant digital receipt

ConnectIPS Summary

- Purpose
 - National digital payment gateway
- Main Uses
 - Tax payment
 - Exam fee payment
 - Government service payment
 - Bank transfer
- Why It Is Important
 - Promotes cashless economy
 - Improves financial transparency
 - Reduces corruption risk
- Example Scenario
 - Student pays university fee online.

Digital Wallet Ecosystem

- Supports financial inclusion
- Utility bill payment
- Online commerce support
- Promotes digital economy

Digital Wallet Pros and Cons

- Pros:
 - Fast payment
 - Convenience
 - Cashless transaction support
- Cons:
 - Fraud risk
 - Internet dependency
 - Device requirement

Digital Wallet Summary

- Platforms:
 - eSewa
 - Khalti
 - IME Pay
- Purpose
 - Support digital financial transactions
- Main Uses
 - Utility bill payment
 - Online shopping
 - Money transfer
- Why It Is Important
 - Financial inclusion
 - Convenient payment system
- Example Scenario
 - Citizen pays electricity bill using mobile wallet.

Online Passport Application System

- Online appointment booking
 - Digital form submission
 - Reduces crowd congestion
 - Limits middleman involvement

Passport System – Before vs After

- **Before:**
 - Unpredictable queue waiting time
 - Multiple office visits
- **After:**
 - Scheduled appointment service
 - SMS notification system

Passport Digital System Summary

- Purpose
 - Appointment-based passport service
- Main Uses
 - Online form submission
 - SMS notification
 - Service tracking
- Why It Is Important
 - Reduces crowd congestion
 - Limits middleman activity
- Example Scenario
 - Citizen visits passport office only on scheduled time.

Infrastructure Support – Government IT Authority

- Government data hosting center
- Supports digital service systems
- Maintains public IT infrastructure
- Centralized governance architecture

Infrastructure Support – Government IT Authority

Purpose

- Host government digital applications and databases
- Provide secure storage for public service systems
- Support centralized digital governance

Main Uses

- Store citizen service records
- Maintain government website and application hosting
- Support e-governance portals
- Enable inter-department data sharing

Infrastructure Support – Government IT Authority

Why It Is Important

- Improves data security and system reliability
 - Reduces duplication of government IT infrastructure
 - Supports centralized administration architecture
 - Helps disaster recovery and system backup
- Example Scenario
 - When a citizen uses the Nagarik App, the request is processed through the centralized government hosting infrastructure.

Broadband Expansion Policy

- Purpose

- Provide internet access to rural and remote areas
- Support digital public services
- Promote digital inclusion
- Enable online education, banking, and government services

- Main Uses

- Rural broadband network expansion
- Support e-governance platforms
- Improve communication infrastructure
- Enable mobile and online services

Broadband Expansion Policy

- Why It Is Important
 - Reduces urban–rural digital gap
 - Allows citizens to access government services online
 - Supports digital economy growth
 - Helps education and healthcare access
- Example Scenario
 - A student in a mountain district attends online learning classes using broadband internet instead of traveling long distances.

Discussion

- Imagine Nepal becomes fully digital:
 - Birth registration automatic
 - Land records fully online
 - Certificates stored digitally
 - Question: Will government offices disappear?

Rural Digital Access Reality

- Urban areas have higher digital access
 - Rural areas face internet limitations
 - Device affordability issues exist
 - Digital literacy gap remains

Challenges in Nepal

- Cybersecurity risk
- Infrastructure inequality
- Organizational resistance
- Funding constraints

Future Direction

- Artificial intelligence governance
- Blockchain transparency systems
- Smart municipality services
- Cloud-based administration

Summary

- Nepal is in digital transformation phase
- Major initiatives improving governance
- Infrastructure and literacy challenges remain